

Goals and ambitions

Goals and ambitions help to give people a sense of direction and focus. From achieving at school, succeeding at sports, or getting a particular job, a person's goals and ambitions are hopes for the future that inspire and excite them.

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Looking forward

A goal or ambition is a strong desire to do or to achieve something. Some are small and can be achieved sooner, while others are much longer term, such as going to college or having a career in a particular industry. This type of goal or ambition usually includes lots of smaller activities along the way, which can be thought of as stepping stones—specific hurdles to overcome in order to achieve the long-term aim.



△ In the short term

Acting in a school play involves short-term goals that require a teen to learn their lines and scenes in a short period of time in order to succeed.



△ In the long term

Planning ahead, such as for becoming an actor, requires teens to imagine their future so they can start working toward it.

Setting goals and ambitions

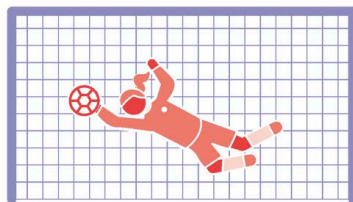
The best way for teens to set goals and ambitions is to think about what interests, inspires, and excites them. These ideas can be very personal and can be kept private if a person prefers.

"You must expect great things of yourself before you can do them."
Michael Jordan, basketball player



School achievements

Being motivated to attain a particular position—for example, being the best at a subject—is a common aim for teens who want to achieve big things.



Perfecting a skill

Focusing on perfecting a skill, such as diving for the ball in soccer, is something some teens strive for.



Trying things out

Other teens enjoy a variety of challenges, and prefer to pursue many goals at once, perhaps learning an instrument, training for sports, and studying all at the same time.